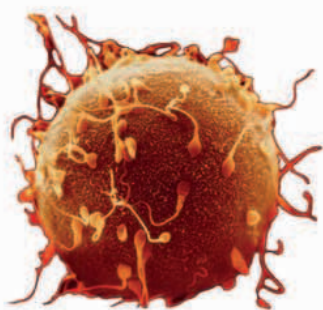
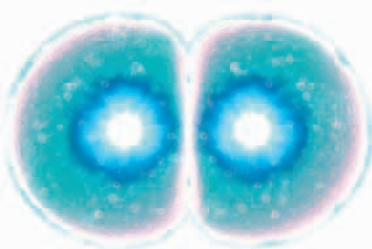




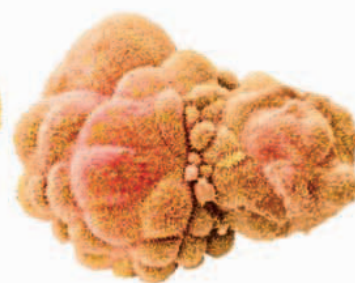
▲ **FERTILIZATION** Sperm mass around an egg cell. One succeeds in entering and fertilizing the egg.



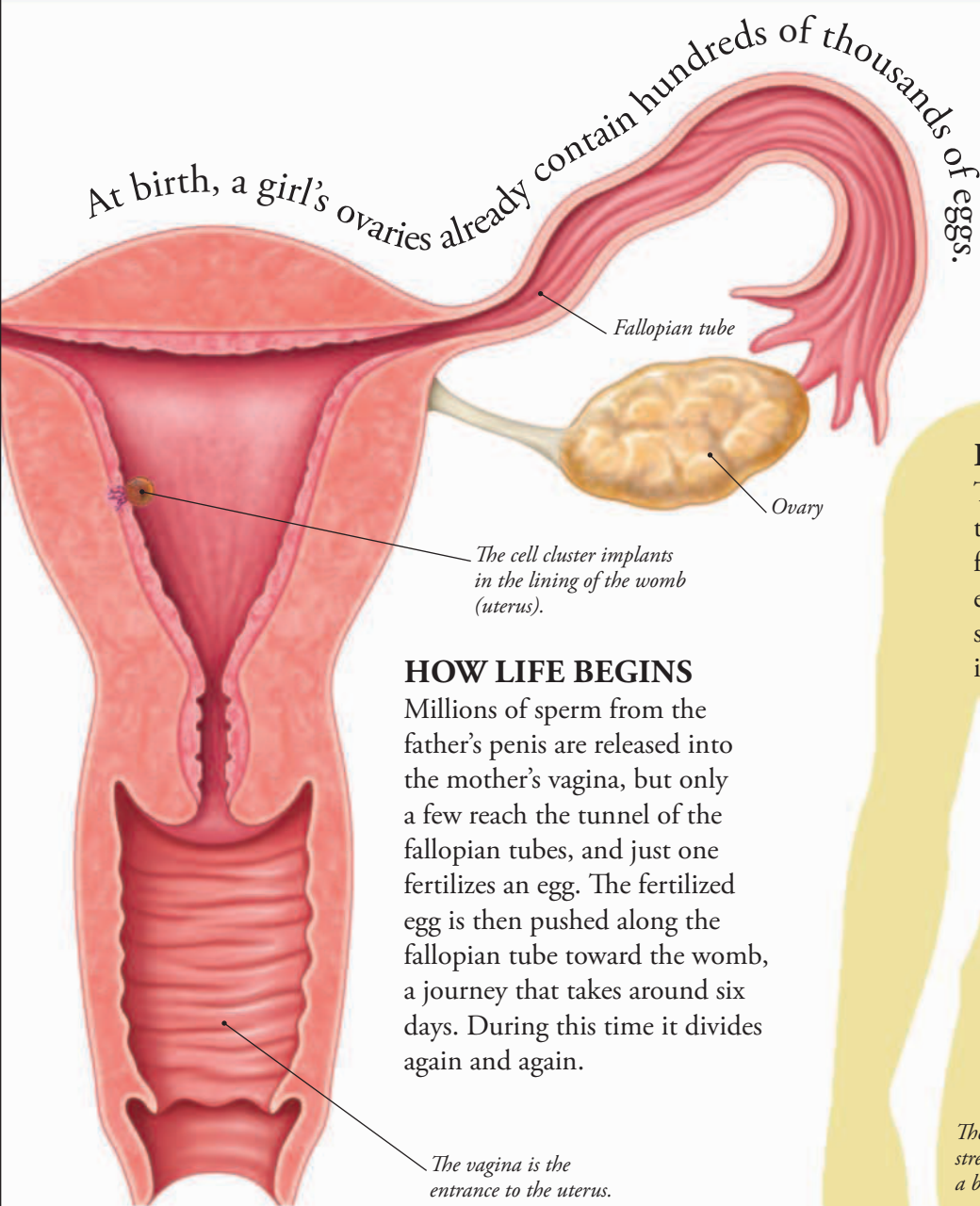
▲ **TWO CELLS** Around 36 hours after fertilization, the egg divides into two linked cells.



▲ **CELL DIVISION** Three days after fertilization, cell division creates a berrylike morula made of 16 cells.



▲ **CLUSTER OF CELLS** A hollow blastocyst forms six days after fertilization. Its inner cells will develop into the embryo.



HOW LIFE BEGINS

Millions of sperm from the father's penis are released into the mother's vagina, but only a few reach the tunnel of the fallopian tubes, and just one fertilizes an egg. The fertilized egg is then pushed along the fallopian tube toward the womb, a journey that takes around six days. During this time it divides again and again.

FEMALE SYSTEM

The main female sex organs are inside the pelvis. Each month an egg is released from one of two ovaries. If fertilized, the egg travels along a fallopian tube and settles in the lining of the womb, where it develops into a baby.

